

Walmart Smart Retail

Store Operations & Product Knowledge Base

Internal Reference Document — 2024

This document contains store policies, product catalogue, return procedures, inventory guidelines, and customer service protocols for use by staff and AI assistant systems.

1. Store Policies

1.1 Store Operating Hours

All Walmart stores operate Monday through Sunday, 7:00 AM to 11:00 PM. Supercenter locations operate 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. Holiday hours may vary — stores close early on Christmas Eve (6:00 PM) and are closed on Christmas Day. Thanksgiving Day stores open at 6:00 AM and close at 10:00 PM.

1.2 Return & Refund Policy

Walmart accepts returns within 90 days of purchase for most items. Electronics must be returned within 30 days and must include all original packaging and accessories. Items returned without a receipt will receive store credit at the current selling price. The following items are non-returnable: opened software, downloadable content, gift cards, prescription medications, and hazardous materials.

For online orders, customers may return items by mail or at any Walmart store. Free return shipping is provided for most online purchases. Refunds are processed within 3-5 business days to the original payment method.

1.3 Price Match Policy

Walmart offers price matching against local competitors and select online retailers including Amazon, Target, and Best Buy. To request a price match, the customer must present proof of the competitor's current price at the time of purchase. Price matching is not available on doorbusters, clearance items, limited-time offers, or items sold by third-party marketplace sellers.

1.4 Customer Service Protocol

Customer service desks are available at the front of every store. Staff are trained to greet customers within 10 seconds of approach. Escalation procedures: Level 1 issues (general queries) are handled by floor associates. Level 2 issues (complaints, refunds over \$100) require a department manager. Level 3 issues (legal, safety, theft) require the store manager on duty.

1.5 Loyalty Program — Walmart+

Walmart+ membership costs \$12.95 per month or \$98 per year. Benefits include free delivery on orders over \$35, fuel discounts of 10 cents per gallon at Walmart and Murphy gas stations, free shipping with no minimum order on Walmart.com, and access to Paramount+ streaming.

Members earn 2% cashback on all in-store and online purchases.

2. Product Catalogue

2.1 Grocery & Fresh Produce

Walmart stores carry over 120,000 grocery SKUs across all departments. The fresh produce section stocks over 400 varieties of fruits and vegetables, sourced from local farms where possible. The Great Value private label brand offers equivalent quality at 20-30% lower prices than national brands.

Category	Avg SKU Count	Avg Price Range	Top Brand
Fresh Produce	400+	\$0.50 - \$8.00	Local / Organic
Dairy & Eggs	250+	\$1.50 - \$12.00	Great Value
Bakery	180+	\$1.00 - \$15.00	Marketside
Frozen Foods	600+	\$2.00 - \$18.00	Great Value
Beverages	500+	\$0.75 - \$25.00	Coca-Cola / Pepsi
Snacks & Candy	700+	\$0.50 - \$20.00	Frito-Lay

2.2 Electronics Department

The electronics department carries TVs, laptops, tablets, smartphones, gaming consoles, smart home devices, and accessories. Walmart offers Walmart Protection Plans (extended warranties) on all electronics purchases. Coverage starts at \$3.00/month for small devices and \$15.00/month for TVs and laptops.

Product	Price Range	Top Brands	Warranty Available
4K Smart TVs	\$198 - \$1,500	Samsung, LG, TCL	Yes (2-5 yr)
Laptops	\$199 - \$1,200	HP, Dell, Lenovo	Yes (2-3 yr)
Smartphones	\$49 - \$999	Apple, Samsung	Yes (1-2 yr)
Tablets	\$59 - \$599	Apple, Amazon Fire	Yes (1-2 yr)
Gaming Consoles	\$299 - \$499	Sony, Microsoft	Yes (1-3 yr)
Smart Home	\$19 - \$250	Google, Amazon	Yes (1 yr)

2.3 Clothing & Apparel

Walmart carries men's, women's, and children's clothing under brands including George, Time and Tru, Terra and Sky, and Wonder Nation. Sizes range from XS to 5XL for adults. Seasonal collections are updated quarterly. School uniform sections are available year-round at select stores.

2.4 Health & Pharmacy

Walmart pharmacies are open Monday through Friday 9:00 AM to 9:00 PM, Saturday 9:00 AM to 7:00 PM, and Sunday 10:00 AM to 6:00 PM. Walmart offers \$4 generic prescriptions on a list of over 300 medications. Immunizations including flu, COVID-19, shingles, and travel vaccines are available without appointment at most pharmacy locations.

3. Inventory & Stock Management

3.1 Reorder Thresholds

Automatic reorder is triggered when inventory falls below the safety stock level. Safety stock is calculated as: average daily demand multiplied by lead time in days multiplied by a safety factor of 1.5. High-demand items (top 20% by sales velocity) have a safety factor of 2.0. Perishables are managed with a 2-day rolling forecast.

3.2 Seasonal Demand Planning

Seasonal peaks are planned 8 weeks in advance. Key retail seasons are: Back to School (July-August), Halloween (September-October), Thanksgiving and Black Friday (November), Christmas (November-December), and Easter (March-April). During peak seasons, safety stock multipliers are increased by 50%. Historical sales data from the past 3 years is used for demand forecasting.

3.3 Shrinkage and Loss Prevention

Acceptable shrinkage rate is under 1.5% of total inventory value. Shrinkage categories: shoplifting (45%), employee theft (28%), vendor fraud (6%), administrative error (21%). Anti-theft measures include EAS tags on items over \$20, RFID tracking on high-value electronics, and LP associates on the floor during peak hours.

4. Demand Forecasting Guidelines

Demand forecasting at Walmart uses a combination of time-series models and machine learning. Weekly sales data is collected across all stores and aggregated at the store-SKU level. Key variables that influence weekly sales include: holiday flag (major holidays increase sales by 15-40% depending on category), temperature (cold weather increases hot food and clothing sales), fuel price (higher fuel prices correlate with reduced footfall), CPI (inflation affects spending on non-essentials), and unemployment rate (negatively correlated with discretionary spending).

Forecasting models are retrained quarterly using the latest 2 years of data. Model performance is evaluated using MAE (Mean Absolute Error) and RMSE. A forecast accuracy of 85% or above is the target threshold for all store-level predictions.

5. Customer FAQ

Q: How do I track my online order?

A: Log into your Walmart account at walmart.com and visit the Order History section. You will find real-time tracking information for all shipped orders. Alternatively, use the tracking number provided in your shipping confirmation email.

Q: Can I return an item without a receipt?

A: Yes, Walmart accepts returns without a receipt. You will receive store credit at the current selling price. Returns without receipt are limited to 3 per year per customer. A valid government-issued ID is required.

Q: Does Walmart offer installation services?

A: Yes, Walmart offers installation services for TVs, car electronics, appliances, and smart home devices through Handy, a third-party service provider. Installation can be added at checkout on walmart.com or at the customer service desk in-store.

Q: What payment methods are accepted?

A: Walmart accepts Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Discover, Walmart Gift Cards, Walmart Pay, Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal, EBT/SNAP for eligible items, and cash at in-store registers.

Q: How does Walmart+ free delivery work?

A: Walmart+ members receive free next-day and two-day delivery on orders over \$35 with no delivery fee. Same-day delivery is available in select markets for an additional express fee. Grocery delivery is included with Walmart+.

Q: What is the Walmart protection plan?

A: The Walmart Protection Plan extends your manufacturer warranty and covers accidental damage for electronics and appliances. Plans start at \$2/month and are managed by Allstate Protection Plans. Claims can be filed online or by calling 1-877-968-6391.

Q: How do I check if an item is in stock at my local store?

A: Use the Walmart app or visit walmart.com, search for the item, and select your local store from the store picker. In-store availability is updated in real time. You can also use the Store Map feature in the app to locate the exact aisle.